

Supported Git and Safari versions

Both floors below are derived from something the codebase actually depends on, not asserted. Where the evidence is thin, that's said explicitly rather than rounded up to a plausible-sounding number.

Git: 2.32 or later

Why 2.32: the `GIT_CONFIG_GLOBAL` environment variable — which lets git-vista's write path pin the global-config file it reads without touching `$HOME`, so it can override a user's `core.hooksPath` or credential helper deterministically rather than trusting whatever the ambient environment provides — was added in Git 2.32 (June 2021). Below that version the variable does not exist and config isolation falls back to weaker mechanisms.

This floor is tied to the git-process-execution-policy work landing in #66 (M1.13, in progress in a parallel session as of this writing), which is what actually depends on `GIT_CONFIG_GLOBAL`. That policy is not yet merged to `main`, so as of this doc nothing on `main` strictly requires 2.32 yet — the number is documented now because it's the floor the in-flight design commits to, and because current dev/CI environments already comfortably clear it (see below), so recording it early costs nothing and avoids the floor drifting undocumented once #66 lands.

- **Empirically confirmed:** this repo's dev environment and this session's test runs are on **git 2.43.0** (`git --version`), well above the 2.32 floor.
- **CI:** `ubuntu-latest` GitHub-hosted runners currently ship a git version in the same 2.4x range, also clear of the floor. No CI job pins or checks the git version explicitly today — that would be worth adding once #66's policy actually ships and the floor becomes load-bearing rather than forward-looking. Flagged, not done here (out of this task's scope).

Safari: 16.4 or later (iOS/iPadOS 16.4, and the matching macOS Safari 16.4)

Why 16.4: the frontend's app shell and full-screen overlays size themselves with the CSS dynamic-viewport-height unit (`dvh`), specifically to track the real visible box under Safari's collapsing/expanding URL and tab bars rather than the static `100vh`, which on iOS undercounts or overcounts depending on chrome state. The code states this directly — see `crates/git-vista/styles.css`, three call sites (`.app`, the menu inline `max-height`, and the full-screen viewer), each with the comment `iOS 16.4+: track the real visible box under Safari's bars`. Safari (all platforms) shipped `dvh / svh / lvh` support in 16.4, released March 2023.

Each of those three call sites sets `100vh` first and `100dvh` second (later declarations win), so a browser that doesn't understand `dvh` falls back to the static unit rather than breaking — the floor is a *quality* floor, not a hard cutoff below which the app fails to render, and `docs/IPAD_DESIGN.md`'s

"Browser and PWA Requirements" section separately asks to "test current Safari/iPadOS... do not depend on a WebKit-only feature for correctness," which is consistent with graceful degradation rather than a hard gate.

- **Evidence used:** the in-code comment in `styles.css` and the `dvh / vh` fallback pattern itself. `docs/IPAD_DESIGN.md` asks for "modern dynamic viewport units" and "current Safari/iPadOS" testing but does not itself state a version number, so 16.4 is derived from the CSS feature's actual ship date, not asserted from that doc.
- **Evidence not available:** no CI job or manual test matrix currently pins or verifies a minimum Safari version against a real device/simulator — `docs/IPAD_DESIGN.md`'s "Validation Matrix" section lists device/orientation combinations to cover but not a version floor to enforce. If a hard floor (rather than a graceful-degradation target) is wanted, that needs an explicit decision and a device/BrowserStack-class check, neither of which exists today.

Signed: thomas2010 · 2026-07-27T20:51:16-04:00